SAN DIEGO COUNTY
MEASURE A

(This Measure will appear on the ballot in the following form.)

MEASURE A

A TRANSPARENT, ACCOUNTABLE, MODERN COUNTY GOVERNMENT Shall the San Diego County Charter be amended to establish an Independent Ethics Commission, Independent Budget Analyst, Independent Program Auditor, confirmation of certain senior County leaders, and optional Board of Supervisors appointment of the Public Defender; increase term limits from two to three terms for the Board of Supervisors members; require public disclosure of spending and performance data; clarify non-interference provisions; and update terminology and structure?

This measure requires Simple Majority (50%+1) of those voting on the measure.

COUNTY COUNSEL IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS

BALLOT MEASURE TO AMEND COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO CHARTER

The Board of Supervisors ("Board") for the County of San Diego ("County") placed this measure on the ballot. If approved by a majority of the votes cast, this measure will amend the County Charter ("Charter") as specified in full text of the ballot measure.

The Charter provides for the structure of the County's government, including the powers and duties of its officers. The Charter can only be amended with voter approval.

The following summarizes the amendments to the Charter proposed by this measure:

- Increase County Supervisors' term limits from two terms to three terms. This amendment would allow a person to serve in the role of County Supervisor for a maximum of twelve years, as opposed to the current maximum of eight years. Any current or former Supervisor's prior time in office would count towards this three-term limit.
- Require the Board to establish a procedure to review and confirm Chief Administrative Officer appointment of the Assistant Chief Administrative Officer, Deputy Chief Administrative Officers, Director of the Office of Emergency Services, Public Health Officer, and Public Defender. The Board shall have the power to remove such officers, with or without cause, by 4/5ths vote.
- The Board may appoint an Independent Budget Analyst and Independent Program Auditor. These new positions would perform specified audit and budget services as directed by the Board or, for the Independent Budget Analyst a County Supervisor. The Board may appoint one person to serve in both positions.
- The Board may change Public Defender to a Board appointment rather than Chief Administrative Officer appointment and may appoint additional officers that do not duplicate the Chief Administrative Officer's functions.
- Provides examples of permissible practices that County Supervisors may engage in without violating the non-interference clause.
- Update Charter to state that no County Officer may influence the Director of Purchasing and Contracting for illegal personal gain or as prohibited by Charter's non-interference clause. Currently, the Charter provides that no County Officer may influence Purchasing Agent in performance of duty and that Board may only conduct official business with Purchasing Agent at a regular Board meeting.
- Change Citizen Advisory Board to Community Advisory Board and update appointment criteria.
- Direct Board to establish an Ethics Commission of seven commissioners to be confirmed by the Board; one appointed by each County Supervisor and two by County Counsel. Commissioners are subject to removal, term limits, and certain qualifications as specified in the full measure text and may be granted subpoena power.
- Require the Auditor and Controller to post all County spending data to the County's website and order an annual independent financial and performance audit of County expenditures, made available to the public.
- Clarify that regulation of political activities does not prohibit activities allowed by law.
- Update prohibition against nepotism by specifying degree of relation.
- Updates Charter structure and terminology.

A "yes" vote is a vote in favor of the proposed Charter amendments.

A "no" vote is a vote against amending the Charter.